

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel | Detection Engineering | Incident Response | CrowdStrike | KQL

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security analyst and security engineer with over five years of experience in advanced threat monitoring, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection engineering, alert triage, and end-to-end incident response. In my current senior role at the University of the Arts, London (UAL), I lead SIEM-driven security operations for over 8,000 users, using Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL) to build and enhance detection rules, triage security alerts, and respond to advanced cyber threats across a complex Microsoft 365 and Azure environment. I am highly proficient in Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) tooling including CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and I bring a strong practical background in log analysis, forensic investigation fundamentals, and incident response covering investigation, containment, and recovery. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, have deep familiarity with the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and am ready to apply my expertise monitoring and responding to advanced cyber threats in a high-stakes environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (primary) - detection rule authoring, KQL analytics, dashboards, incident investigation; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **EDR/XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender; CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover) - Expert
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL-based correlation rules; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage; behavioural detection; Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Alert Triage and Threat Analysis:** Tier 2 and Tier 3 alert investigation; false positive reduction; attack chain reconstruction; kill chain analysis
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework; investigation, containment, eradication, and recovery; forensic triage; root cause analysis
- **Log Analysis and Forensics:** Windows Event Log analysis; Azure AD / Entra ID sign-in and audit log review; endpoint telemetry analysis; network log correlation; forensic investigation fundamentals
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Conditional Access / MFA / SSO; identity threat detection via MDI
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); AppCheck; Nessus
- **Automation/Scripting:** PowerShell (SOAR automation, playbook development, bulk remediation)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast; phishing analysis and Business Email Compromise (BEC) investigation
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK; NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF); ISO 27001; CIS Controls; Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Monitor and respond to advanced cyber threats across an 8,000-user Microsoft 365 and Azure environment, using Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM tool for detection, triage, investigation, and response.
- Triage security alerts across multiple detection platforms (Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft 365 Defender), analysing threats, correlating indicators, and determining scope and severity to prioritise response actions.
- Build, tune, and enhance detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), creating analytics rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to improve detection coverage and reduce false positive rates.

- Lead investigations for Tier 2 and Tier 3 security incidents, performing log analysis, endpoint forensic triage via CrowdStrike Falcon and MDE, Azure AD and Entra ID sign-in log review, and attack chain reconstruction from initial access to impact.
- Carry out incident response through the full lifecycle (investigation, triage, containment, eradication, and recovery) in line with the NIST 800-61 incident response framework, producing detailed post-incident reports and lessons-learned documentation.
- Perform log analysis across Windows Event Logs, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) audit and sign-in logs, network device logs, and endpoint telemetry to identify indicators of compromise (IoCs) and tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs).
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM using PowerShell and Logic Apps, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume, repeatable alert types.
- Administer the CrowdStrike Falcon platform (EDR Prevent, Insight, and Discover) for endpoint threat detection, real-time process visibility, and automated threat containment across the full estate.
- Oversee Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) alerting for identity-based attack techniques including pass-the-hash, Kerberoasting, lateral movement, and privilege escalation attempts.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying low-and-slow attacker activity not surfaced by automated detection rules.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, analysing threats using SIEM tools and escalating confirmed incidents within agreed SLA windows with full structured investigation reports.
- Enhanced detection rules and analytics in Microsoft Sentinel, writing KQL queries to improve alerting fidelity, reduce dwell time, and increase detection coverage against common adversary techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Performed log analysis across multiple data sources (Windows Event Logs, Azure AD sign-in logs, MDE telemetry, Mimecast audit logs) to support threat analysis and forensic investigation fundamentals during incident response.
- Deployed and tuned Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) detection rules, attack surface reduction (ASR) policies, and automated investigation and response (AIR) capabilities for 8,000 endpoints.
- Led incident response for phishing, malware, ransomware, and data exfiltration events, performing triage, containment, eradication, and recovery in line with NIST 800-61, and producing detailed post-incident reports for management.
- Supported rollout of MFA/SSO enforcement via Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, and assisted with Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment to detect and alert on identity-based attack techniques.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing prioritised remediation reports for infrastructure teams and tracking findings to closure.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) – IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Monitored and responded to security alerts across cloud and on-premises infrastructure in a SaaS FinTech environment, triaging events and escalating confirmed incidents for further investigation.
- Analysed Windows Event Logs, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) audit logs, and firewall logs to identify anomalous activity, unauthorised access attempts, and policy violations.
- Conducted internal vulnerability scans using Nessus, triaged findings by severity and business risk, and tracked remediation to closure with DevOps and infrastructure teams.
- Managed Azure AD identity governance, performing access reviews, enforcing MFA and Conditional Access policies, and maintaining least-privilege access controls in support of SOC 2 and ISO 27001 compliance requirements.
- Supported security incident handling procedures and maintained incident response documentation, contributing to the organisation's security operations capability in a fast-growth, globally distributed environment.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and continuously enhanced a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection rule library using KQL, delivering improved MITRE ATT&CK coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud attack vectors and reducing false positive alert volume.
- Deployed and tuned Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users at UAL, creating a fully integrated EDR/XDR detection and response capability covering endpoint, identity, and email attack surfaces.
- Led incident response investigations for multiple high-severity security events at UAL, achieving containment and recovery within defined SLA timescales and producing detailed post-incident reports that informed ongoing detection improvements.
- Delivered 100 per cent CrowdStrike Falcon EDR coverage across 8,000+ endpoints, enabling real-time behavioural telemetry, automated prevention, and threat hunting capability across the full estate.
- Automated SIEM/SOAR response playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM using PowerShell, significantly reducing manual analyst effort for high-volume, repeatable alert types and accelerating mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, supporting the organisation's compliance posture and demonstrating security control effectiveness to external assessors.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP80,000–GBP90,000 | Hybrid (London, UK)